No. 13 RECEIVED JUL 8 1867

Legation of the United States.
Peking. April 23d 1867.

Sir,

I yesterday received through the British Minister, Sir Rutherford Alcock, a despatch from Charles Carroll, British Consul at Taiwan, Formosa, covering a report of Capt. G. D. Broad of Her Majesty's Naval Service, from which I learn the principal details of the loss of the American Bark Rover and the whole of her crew of eleven persons, who were murdered by the savages, on the South coast of Formosa.

The Rover, Capt Hand, left Swatow for Newchwang, on the 9th of March and on the 12th struck on a rock, South of Formosa, (the Vele Rete rocks) and being in a sinking condition, was abandoned by the Captain and crew, who left in two boats, one of which alone has been heard from. The news was brought by a Chinese Sailor who escaped in the Capt's boat and who after incredible hardships communicated with Capt. Broad and the British authorities at Takow. He says all

Hon. William H. Seward
Sec'y of State.

all but himself, were killed, immediately after landing, by a musketry fire from the woods. Capt. Broad, upon learning this news, immediately tried to save the lives of those who might be living, by sending offers of ransom. He, subsequently, accompanied by the British Consul, Mr. Carell, with the "Cormorant," steamed to the place pointed out by the Chinaman, where the murder was committed and where the "Rover's" boat was found. While landing, Capt. Broad and party were fired upon and with difficulty escaped, under cover of a fire from the "Cormorant" After shelling the woods, Capt Broad returned to Takow.

I give these brief details only, as you have doubtless heard all the particulars long before this will reach you, from our Consuls at the South. I had previously heard a rumor of this affair, from our Consul at Amoy, Mr. Le Gendre who informed me that he was about to visit the place with the war-vessel "Ashuelot." I immediately called the attention of the Chinese Government to the above facts and received from it, every possible expression of regret for the murders and proffers of aid to punish the guilty parties. I wrote, at once, to Admiral Bell, requesting him to co-operate with the Chinese authorities in such manner as the case might require. I wrote also to our Consul, Mr. Le Gendre, in the same sense, requesting him to thank at once the British Consul, Mr. Charles Carroll and Capt. Broad in the name of our Government, and to say to them that I would thank them officially, through the British Minister here and at the same time would call their attention of our government to their noble conduct.

These savages are not Chinese, but outlaws of another race, who from time immemorial have been a sort of wrecking banditti. The Chinese and the British Minister unite with me in a general movement against them.

I will advise you, as I learn of the progress made.

I have the honor to be
Sir,
Your obedient Servant,
Anson Burlingame